improving relations with the Soviets and that my experience at Geneva gave me hope for the future. “I can’t claim that we had a meeting of the minds on such fundamentals as ideology or national purpose,” I said, “but we understand each other better and that’s a key to peace . . . we have a long way to go, but we’re heading in the right direction. . . .”

I think the enthusiastic cheering and stomping in the chamber of the House of Representatives that night as I delivered my report from Geneva spoke for all peoples of the world who shared a hope for lasting peace in the nuclear age.

Afterward, I wrote in my diary: “I haven’t gotten such a reception since I was shot.”

We had made a start but, as we were to learn, some of the euphoria was premature.